

Tailoring Guide: Basic Measurements & Stitching

1. Introduction

Tailoring begins with accurate measurements and proper stitching techniques. Correct measurements ensure a good fit, while quality stitching improves durability and appearance.

2. Essential Body Measurements

Bust Waist Hip Shoulder Width Sleeve Length Armhole Blouse Length Neck Circumference

3. Measuring Tips

Use a flexible measuring tape. Measure over light clothing. Keep the tape snug but not tight. Record measurements immediately.

4. Basic Stitch Types

Running Stitch Back Stitch Lock Stitch Zigzag Stitch Overlock Stitch

5. Cutting Guidelines

Pre-wash fabric before cutting if shrinkage is expected. Lay fabric flat, align the grainline, pin the pattern securely, and use sharp fabric scissors.

6. Sewing Best Practices

Choose the correct needle for the fabric. Match thread weight to fabric weight. Test stitches on scrap fabric first. Press seams during construction.

7. Common Mistakes

Incorrect seam allowance Skipping fabric pressing Using a dull needle Ignoring grain direction

8. Summary

Accurate measurements, careful cutting, and proper stitching techniques are the foundation of professional tailoring.